

Grade 2 Coding

Scratch: Backgrounds & Scenes

A fun, hands-on lesson for young coders!

■ What You'll Learn Today

- What backgrounds (backdrops) are in Scratch
- Why backgrounds make projects exciting
- How to add and switch backdrops
- How scenes help you tell a story

1. What Are Backgrounds?

Backgrounds are pictures that show **where your story or game happens**. Every Scratch project has a stage, and the background fills that stage with colour and life!

■ *Did You Know?*

In Scratch, backgrounds are called "**Backdrops**." You can choose one from the library, upload a photo, or even draw your own!

2. Why Use Backgrounds?

■ Set the Scene

■ Make It Fun & Help Players

3. Adding Backgrounds in Scratch

Follow these four easy steps to add a backdrop to your Scratch project:



Click the "**Choose a Backdrop**" button in the bottom-right corner of the Scratch screen.



Pick a picture from the **Backdrop Library**, or upload your own photo.



Click the backdrop to add it to your project.



See it appear **behind your sprites** on the stage!

4. What Are Scenes?

Scenes are like **different pages in your story**, each with its own background. Every scene shows a new place or moment in your project!

■ *Scenes = Different Backgrounds*

Just like a book has different pages, your Scratch project can have different scenes — each with a unique backdrop to tell your story **step by step!**

5. Using Scenes to Tell Stories

■ **Start Scene**

Introduce your characters and setting — let the audience know **where the story begins!** Use a bright, welcoming background to set the mood.

■ **Middle Scene**

Show the **action or problem** your character faces. Change the backdrop to signal that something new is happening!

■ **Ending Scene**

Reveal how the story **finishes** with a new backdrop. This tells the audience the adventure is complete!

6. Switching Backgrounds with Code

In Scratch, you can change the background using a special code block. This lets you switch scenes and tell exciting stories!

■ **Switch Backdrop Block**

Find it in the **Looks** blocks palette:

switch backdrop to [name]

Place it wherever you want the scene to change — like when a character moves or a button is clicked!

7. Example Projects

■ A Day at the Park

This project uses a **park background** to tell a fun story. Animated characters play, walk, and talk in a sunny park setting — all made by a Grade 2 student!

■ Space Adventure

This project **switches from a starry space background** to the inside of a spaceship. Each backdrop tells a different part of the adventure using the **"switch backdrop"** block!

8. Tips for Choosing Backgrounds

- Pick **bright and colourful** pictures
- Choose backgrounds that **match your story**
- Use **different backgrounds** for different scenes
- Try **drawing your own backdrop** in Scratch!

■ Practice Time! Your Challenge

Open Scratch and complete these steps:

1. **Add a background** — pick your favourite place or dream location.
2. **Switch to a second scene** using the switch backdrop block.
3. **Place a sprite** in your project.
4. **Share your creation** with the class!

Recap: What We Learned Today!

■ Backgrounds Show Location

Backgrounds are pictures that show where your story or game happens in Scratch!

■ Scenes Tell Stories

Scenes are different backgrounds used to tell each part of your story — like pages in a book!

■ Easy to Add & Switch!

You can add and switch backgrounds easily in Scratch using the backdrop library and the switch backdrop block!

Next Steps for Young Coders!

■ Add More Scenes

Try adding more scenes to your Scratch projects and use different backdrops to make your story more exciting!

→ ■ Draw & Share

Experiment with **drawing your own backgrounds** in Scratch. Then share your amazing project with friends and family!

"Your Imagination is the Limit!"

Dream up any place — a jungle, outer space, or your own backyard — and paint it into your Scratch project. The more creative you are, the more amazing your project will be!